

system will be able to manipulate the prices to get the most amount of money out of your pockets.

Encrypt everything

Encryption is important. You must know about those ransomware attacks, where the attackers encrypt all your data and demand money for it? Basically, what they do is devalue your information by writing it in their own language. That is what you need to do. All the data you have, you can also devalue your own data by writing it in your own language. When it does not make sense to anyone, how will they use it to their advantage? That's the point of this whole exercise.

How you do it depends on the system that you are working with. On Windows, there is an easy inbuilt tool called BitLocker. It is very easy to use and set up. For MacBooks, it is called FileVault. Both these tools are very effective and can help you get the work done without much hassle. For mobile phones, there are a lot of different applications available; most of the well-reviewed ones will secure your data equally well.

When it comes to hard drives and solid-state drives, there are dedicated manufacturer-provided utilities, which you can look up and install, and they are intuitive enough for anyone to set up. One thing that you will need to make sure is that you never lose your encryption password. Because if you do, your data is as unvalued for you as it is for anyone else.

Virtual Private Networks

Use a VPN. That is all that we will say here in this chapter because the next one is pretty much dedicated to VPNs and private browsing. So, see you there!

Back-up

It is good to have a plan B in any situation. And, when it comes down to the currency of today's world, which is data, it becomes all the more important. Backups can be created in two major ways, online and offline. Online backups are the most common option, where you dump all your data on an online service hosted by Google, Microsoft or whatever your preferred choice is. When it comes to offline backups, though, the options are a bit diverse.

The first one is the standard hard/solid-state drive backups, where instead of placing your data on the cloud, and then restoring it from